

Alex Kokot

Ph.D. Candidate in Statistics, University of Washington

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Education

University of Washington, Seattle Sep 2021–June 2026 (Anticipated)

Ph.D. in Statistics. Advisors: Prof. Marina Meilă and Prof. Alex Luedtke.

University of Notre Dame, Notre Dame, IN Aug 2017–May 2021

B.S. in Honors Mathematics and B.A. in Philosophy

Awards and Honors

NDSEG Graduate Fellowship, Dept. of Defense 2023–2026

“For demonstrated ability and special aptitude for advanced training in science and engineering.”

RUA Research Exchange Award, Research University Alliance 2025

“Recognizing evidence of research quality contributing to diversifying the future professoriate.”

Barry Goldwater Scholarship, Goldwater Scholarship Foundation 2020

“Supporting students with exceptional promise of becoming the next generation of research leaders.”

George Kolettis Award in Mathematics, Univ. of Notre Dame 2021

“For a graduating senior excelling in mathematics and contributing notably to the esprit de corps.”

Senior G.E. Prize, Honors Mathematics, Univ. of Notre Dame 2021

“Awarded to a senior honors major who excelled in mathematics in the senior year.”

Phi Beta Kappa, Early Induction, The Phi Beta Kappa Society 2021

“Recognizing outstanding arts and sciences students at America’s leading colleges.”

Charles Edison Fellowship, Notre Dame Scientia 2020

“To promote undergraduate research and help students reach their highest potential.”

Notre Dame Sorin Scholar, Notre Dame CUSE 2018–2021

“For a cohort of students excelling in scholarly engagement and creative endeavor.”

Publications

In Preparation

1. **Alex Kokot**, Alex Luedtke, Marina Meilă (2026) *Diffusion Maps are Entropic Self-Transport: Limits and Applications as $\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$. To be submitted to COLT.*

Submitted

2. Vydhourie Thiyageswaran, **Alex Kokot**, et al. (2026) *Optimal Design under Interference, Homophily, and Robustness Trade-offs.* Submitted to JASA.
3. **Alex Kokot**, et al. (2026). *Local EGOP for Continuous Index Learning.* arXiv:2601.07061. Submitted to AISTATS.
4. **Alex Kokot**, Alex Luedtke (2025). *Coreset selection for the Sinkhorn divergence and generic smooth divergences.* arXiv:2504.20194. Submitted to JMLR (under review).

Peer-Reviewed

5. **Alex Kokot**, Octavian-Vlad Murad, Marina Meilă (2025). *The Noisy Laplacian: A threshold phenomenon for non-linear dimension reduction.* In Proc. 42nd Int’l Conf. on Machine Learning (ICML 2025).

6. Hrafn Traustason, Nicola L. Bell, Kiana Caranto, David C. Auld, David T. Lockey, **Alex M. Kokot**, Jennifer E. S. Szymanowski, Leroy Cronin, Peter C. Burns (2020). *Reactivity, Formation, and Solubility of Polyoxometalates Probed by Calorimetry*. *Journal of the American Chemical Society*.
7. Lei Zhang, Sergey M. Aksenov, **Alex Kokot**, Samuel N. Perry, Travis A. Olds, Peter C. Burns (2020). *Crystal Chemistry and Structural Complexity of Uranium(IV) Sulfates*. *Inorganic Chemistry*.
8. Kulick, J., Nichols, B., Knight, T., Lu, T., Ortega, C., Siders, S., **Kokot, A.**, Bernstein, G. (2019). *Enabling curved hemispherical arrays with Quilt Packaging interconnect technology*. In *Proc. SPIE 10980*.
9. Jie Qiu, Tyler L. Spano, Mateusz Dembowski, **Alex Kokot**, Jakub E. S. Szymanowski, Peter C. Burns (2017). *Sulfate-Centered Sodium-Icosahedron-Templated Uranyl Peroxide Phosphate Cages*. *Inorganic Chemistry*.

Presentations

- Alex Kokot**, Alex Luedtke (2026). *Coreset selection for the Sinkhorn divergence and generic smooth divergences*. Talk at *Kantorovich Initiative Spring Retreat*, University of British Columbia. Vancouver, Canada. Scheduled for March 12–13.
- Alex Kokot**, Anand Hemmady, Vydhourie Thiyageswaran, Marina Meilă (2026). *Local EGOP for Continuous Index Learning*. Talk at *IFDS Weekly Seminar*, University of Washington. Seattle, WA. Scheduled for February 26.
- Alex Kokot**, Octavian-Vlad Murad, Marina Meilă (2025). *The Noisy Laplacian: A threshold phenomenon for non-linear dimension reduction*. Poster presentation at *ICML 2025*, Vancouver, Canada.
- Dippold, B., Klein, I., Agudelo, J. M., & **Kokot, A.** (2021) *Geometric Methods in Computer Vision*. MAA Student Poster Session on Geometry, *Joint Mathematics Meetings (JMM)*.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, UW Statistics 2021–2022
 TA for STAT 390: Probability and Statistics for Engineers. Led weekly quiz sections, graded assignments, and provided weekly office hours for student support.

Service and Outreach

Referee Service: *Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR)*, *AISTATS*, *NeurIPS*.

Outreach & Leadership

- President, Notre Dame Math Club (2020–2021)
- Volunteer, UW Pre-Application Review Service (2021–2022)
- Organizer, UW Statistics Fun Committee (2021–Present)
- Volunteer, UW Math Circle (2021–2022)
- Volunteer, Notre Dame Math Circle (2020–2021)
- Community Service, South Bend Unity Gardens (2021)